

Holistic Healing Modalities (2)

Examples of Alternative therapies

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Objectives:

At the end of this lecture each student will be able to

- Define the Approaches or categories of alternative therapy
- Identify the Popular approaches that may have mental health benefits

Out lines

- **Introduction**
- **Approaches or categories of alternative therapy**
 - **Nutritional**
 - **Physiological**
 - **Physical**
 - **Mind-body techniques**
- **Popular approaches that may have mental health benefits include:**
 - **Ayurveda,**
 - **Meditation,**
 - **Hypnotherapy,**
 - **Acupuncture, and**
 - **Yoga.**

Holistic Healing Modalities (2)

- Alternative therapies refer to any medical treatments that are not traditional medicine techniques. Alternative therapies could either be used alongside conventional medicine or instead of it. The term is often used interchangeably with "complementary medicine." In medical spaces, the practice is referred to as Complementary and Alternative Medicine (CAM).

Approaches or categories of alternative therapy: *These therapies can involve:*

- **Nutritional:** This includes any diets, dietary supplements, probiotics and herbs used in alternative and complementary therapies.
- **Physiological:** This includes alternative therapy practices like meditation and hypnosis.

Approaches or categories of alternative therapy

- **Physical:** This includes practices like acupuncture and massages.
- **Mind-body techniques:** Combination of physiological and physical. These are therapies that affect the mind and body simultaneously. They include [yoga](#), tai-chi, [dance therapy](#), and a host of others.

Popular approaches that may have mental health benefits include:

- Ayurveda,
- Meditation,
- Hypnotherapy,
- Acupuncture, and
- Yoga.



Ayurveda: It's an ancient Indian practice and has been in use for thousands of years. Ayurveda focuses on *using specific herbs, massages, meditation, laxatives, enemas, medical oils and diet techniques* to treat conditions.

- **Herbal medicine.** A key component of Ayurveda, it's used in different combinations includes licorice, red clover, ginger, and turmeric.
- Ayurveda treatments can help with conditions such as osteoarthritis, type 2 diabetes, and colitis (an inflamed colon).

Meditation

The [practice of meditation](#) has been used for many centuries. There are many types of meditation, but the primary aim of meditation practice is to help focus the attention and achieve a state of calm and relaxation. This, in turn, can help to cope with certain disorders and improve overall health and well-being.

Meditation effectively treats symptoms of health conditions such as high blood pressure and mental health conditions like depression and anxiety. It can also help boost immunity and combat stress.

Homeopathy

Homeopathy involves using very watered-down substances to treat a host of ailments from asthma to high blood pressure. It's based on the principle that a substance that causes symptoms can also treat those symptoms.

Homeopaths, that is, people who practice homeopathy, believe that the more a substance is diluted, the more power it has to treat symptoms of a condition.

Hypnotherapy

Hypnotherapy makes use of hypnosis to treat certain conditions. The [hypnosis process](#) involves being guided into a deeply relaxed state, where a hypnotherapist will access subconscious thoughts and beliefs.

A hypnotherapist will give suggestions to help encourage [behavioral change](#) or relieve symptoms.

For instance, hypnotherapy can be used to help treat addiction or stress management.

Acupuncture

Acupuncture is a traditional Chinese medicine technique that involves sticking finely pointed needles in areas of body known as acupuncture points. This practice has historically been used as a natural pain-relieving technique. It's believed that the needles stimulate specific nerves and muscles, releasing natural pain-relieving hormones in body.

Yoga

Yoga has been used for centuries as a healing technique. This ancient Indian practice has been proven to improve the physical and mental well-being of people who practice it.

Yoga has also proven to [help relieve stress](#), manage anxiety, and pain management. Yoga is relatively safe; however, it's advisable to practice with a certified instructor to avoid any sprains or strains.

Massage

- [Therapeutic massages](#) are more focused on helping to treat physical symptoms like pain in certain body parts. They are done by kneading the soft tissues of body until feel relief.
- Massage therapy can have a number of benefits, including helping people deal with symptoms of anxiety, stress, and depression.
- There are different types of massages, and the used kind typically depends on the goal seek to achieve.

Herbal Medicine

- With herbal medicine, parts of a plant such as its leaves, seeds, or roots are processed into treatment for conditions like chronic pain and allergies.
- Herbal medicine can come in different forms, from tea to lotions or pills and powders.

Chiropractic Medicine

- Chiropractic medicine is practiced by a chiropractor. This form of alternative therapy aims to ease pain and improve body function. It uses specific techniques to manipulate the spine, joints, and skeletal system and helps align the body.
- Chiropractic medicine is similar to traditional medicine because chiropractors review medical history, conduct tests and interviews, and provide an official diagnosis before developing a treatment plan.

Reiki

- Reiki is an ancient Japanese form of alternative therapy. It's based on the belief that a human has a "life force energy" flowing within body. When this energy is low, person become sick.
- Reiki aims to restore this energy by laying hands on different parts of the body. Doing so helps with any physical or psychological problems. It's a form of energy therapy.

Benefits of Ayurveda:

- Ayurveda have been shown to improve health and well-being.
- Ayurveda treatments may improve symptoms.
- Ayurveda has also been shown to lower blood pressure and cholesterol.
- An Ayurvedic diet focuses on an increase in eating fruits, vegetables, and whole grains and decreasing meat intake, particularly red meat. This could reduce the risk of heart disease.
- Practicing yoga can reduce chronic pain and anxiety and improve circulation and digestion.

- Lower bad cholesterol (LDL) and increase good cholesterol (HDL).
- Meditation may reduce anxiety, increase focus, manage stress, and improve the quality of sleep. It may also help manage symptoms of conditions like chronic pain, cancer, depression, and irritable bowel syndrome.
- Relieving pain
- Managing some characteristics of ADHD
- Relieving nausea and vomiting caused by chemotherapy
- Managing symptoms of irritable bowel syndrome

A top-down view of a desk with various items. In the center is a spiral-bound notebook with a white cover and the text "ANY QUESTIONS?" in bold, black, sans-serif font. Above the notebook are black-rimmed glasses. To the left is a small potted succulent with green, fleshy leaves. To the right are two yellow sticky notes, one of which has a red pencil resting on it. Below the notebook is a black pen. To the left of the notebook is a small yellow flower and a black object, possibly a stapler or paperweight. The background is a light-colored, textured surface.

**ANY
QUESTIONS?**

A rectangular, light brown paper tag with a hole on the left side, through which a dark, fibrous string is threaded. The tag is placed on a rough, light-colored wooden surface. Several bright green, serrated leaves are scattered around the tag, some in the foreground and some in the background, creating a natural, rustic feel. The text 'Thank you!' is written in a black, cursive script on the tag. A faint 'dreamstime' watermark is visible across the middle of the image.

Thank
you!